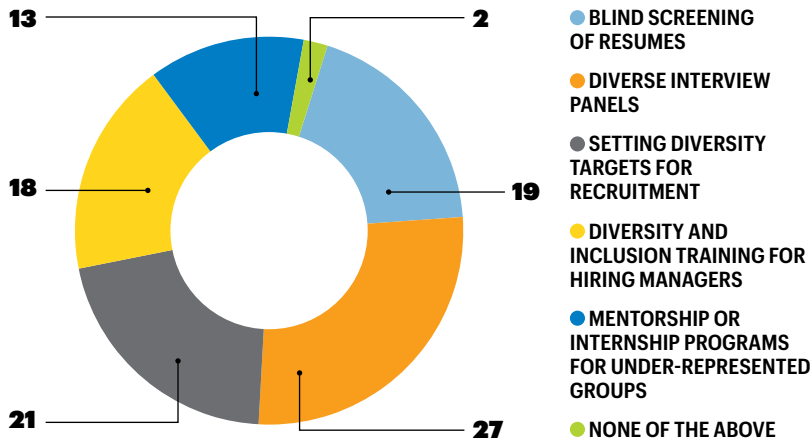


INCLUSIVE STRATEGIES

There are several strategies that organisations intend to use to promote diversity and inclusion

Chief among these is ensuring diversity in the recruiting teams



FIGURES REPRESENT % OF RESPONDENTS

SOURCE TEAMLEASE EMPLOYMENT OUTLOOK REPORT- H2 FY24

Zers, the big question is what a job offers them in terms of personal growth,” says Giri.

A survey by consultancy BCG in December 2023 revealed that employers need to prioritise and invest to understand what really matters to their employees as younger workers were willing to vote with their feet. It found that 26% of Indian employees surveyed were at risk of leaving the following year. “[There] is an urgent need for employers around the world to help their employees find the right balance between functional drivers such as pay and job hours, versus emotional factors such as workplace respect, fairness, and recognition,” said Neetu Chitkara, MD and Partner, who leads the People and Organisational Practice at consultancy BCG India in the report.

According to World Bank data, India has a workforce of 593.7 million. Per industry estimates, 90% are in the informal sector.

But since employability remains a challenge—as many candidates do not possess the requisite skill sets despite having the educational background for it—retaining good talent is vital for companies. Otherwise, it could be an uphill task to hire the right talent.

SKILL BILL

The biggest challenge both employees and employers face is the blistering pace of technological change that is fundamentally altering many jobs. As a result, companies have had to work with employees to reskill and upskill them.

According to ‘The Randstad Workmonitor: The Voice of Talent in 2024’ report, Indian workers continue to prioritise the future-proofing of their skills, particularly in light of the widespread adoption of AI. According to the report, the Top 5 learning opportunities in-

DEMANDS

FLEXIBILITY

Employees seek flexibility to accommodate all their priorities

TRAINING AND UPSKILLING

Organisations must prioritise these to elevate the skills of their workforce

DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

Talent favours employers that take action to improve equity in the workplace

USE OF AI

Workers prioritise the ‘future-proofing’ of their skills as AI/ML are changing job roles

replaced by flexible work options in several sectors; a more socially responsive generation insists on prioritising diversity, equity, and inclusion (D&I) initiatives; and workers continue to prioritise the ‘future-proofing’ of their skills, particularly in light of the widespread adoption of AI.

Yeshab Giri, Chief Commercial Officer of Operational Talent Solutions at talent agency Randstad India, says millennials and the Gen Z are more ambitious, and the onus is on companies to create a supportive environment for them to grow. “Key asks from employees now are work-life balance, pay, job security, career opportunities and mental support, working hour flexibility, and skilling and development,” he says.

He points out that notions of employment and loyalty are also changing. “For millennials and Gen